



Install Adblock Plus to block regular and malicious ads

words. Chances are that sensitive information may be tracked by the attackers. You can disable Dictation by going to Settings > General > Keyboard, and toggling off Dictation. Also, turn off the Diagnostic Data collection by going to Settings > Privacy > Diagnostic & Usage and select Don't Send. You can limit ad tracking by going to the Advertisement section below Diagnostic & Usage and then toggle Limit Ad Tracking to switch it on.

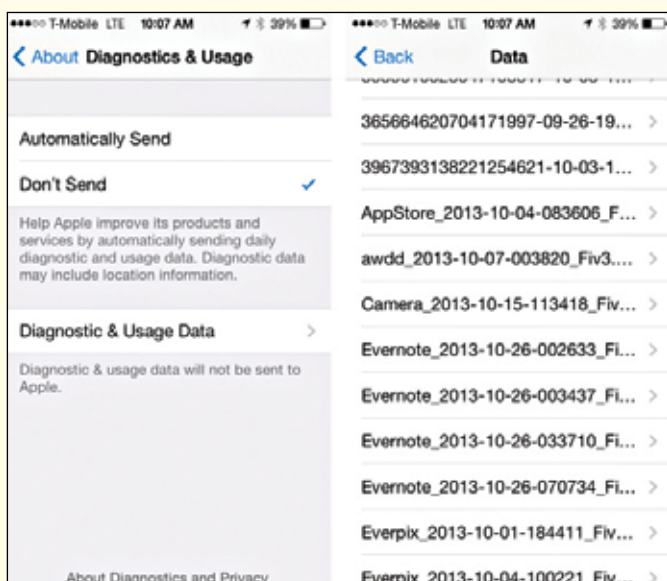
Windows

There is a huge amount of data snooping by Microsoft from its users. Initial agreements while installing Windows on your system, asks permission to track your data to help Microsoft. Apart from Cortana "Getting to know you better" and collecting your data, Microsoft also gathers telemetry data from your device.



Disable voice assistants

Voice assistants are great, they make cumbersome tasks easy with a simple voice command. Siri, Google Now and Cortana are the most popular voice assistants. From asking a basic question like "How is the weather today?" to counting the number of flights overhead, these tasks are done with ease by these products. Many of us rely on them on a daily basis. However, these assistants need to collect a large number of information to give you an efficient service. They access your contact list, calendar, photos and other tons of information. Voice samples are the main piece of information that is collected. This information is shared with the company which invades the privacy of the user.



Have a look on the data that is sent for diagnostic purposes

Android

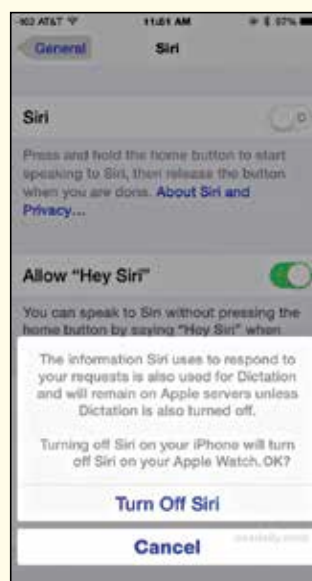
Google Now is Google's personal voice assistant. It can be switched off by opening the Google app and going to Settings > Voice > "Ok Google" detection and toggling of all the options. Let's face it, Google is our first option for any query on the Internet. So, it's difficult to discard the use of Google products but we can certainly stop using "Ok Google" in order to reduce information such as voice, contacts, calendar being shared with company.



Switching off Google Now

iOS

Siri was quite a buzz when it was launched. To switch off Siri, open the Settings app in iOS and go to "General". Tap on "Siri" and near the top of the screen, toggle off the switch next to "Siri". Confirm that you



Toggle off Hey Siri too

wish to disable Siri completely by tapping on "Turn off Siri". If you want to be completely sure that your Voice samples are not stored within Apple's servers, turn off Dictation as well.

Windows

Cortana basically searches your queries through bing.com that means even when Cortana is not switched on, your previous searches are still available with Microsoft. Cortana can be switched off by these steps: Go to Cortana's Notebook > Set-

tings > Turn off Cortana, then restart your phone. When enabled, Cortana requires your personal information, access to contact list, calendar, location and camera. You can completely wipe off Cortana's data from the phone and cloud. To wipe data tap on the head to Cortana's setting menu after turning off Cortana and restarting phone. Then, tap on delete phone's data. To clear Cortana's cloud data, Tap Manage Cloud Data to view the Settings page on the Bing.com dashboard. From here, you can clear your saved places, interests and other Cortana data.



Enable remote locating and erase

Enabling such services on your device will ensure that when your device is stolen you can remotely locate and erase the data on it. Anyone who finds